

Hamptons New York — Startup Budget Breakdown

Date: February 26, 2026

Partners: Sean DeFaria (51%) & Lukas Levine (49%)

1. LLC Formation Costs (One-Time)

| Item | Cost | Notes |

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| ZenBusiness Formation (Starter) | \$0 | State fees separate |

| ZenBusiness Formation (Pro — recommended) | \$199 | Includes operating agreement template, rush processing |

| NY Articles of Organization filing fee | \$200 | Mandatory state fee |

| NY Publication Requirement (Suffolk County) | \$300–\$600 | 6 weeks in 2 newspapers designated by Suffolk County Clerk |

| Certificate of Publication filing fee | \$50 | Filed with NY Dept of State after publication |

| EIN (Employer ID Number) | \$0 | Free from IRS — file Form SS-4 online |

| **Total LLC Formation** | **\$550–\$1,050** | |

Recommendation: ZenBusiness Pro Plan (\$199)

- Includes rush filing, operating agreement template, and business document templates
- Worry-Free Compliance included free first year (renews at \$199/yr)
- You already know the ZenBusiness workflow from your DeFaria LLC

2. Ongoing LLC Costs (Annual/Recurring)

| Item | Cost | Frequency |

|-----|-----|-----|

| ZenBusiness Worry-Free Compliance | \$199/yr | Annual (after Year 1) |

| NY Biennial Statement | \$9 | Every 2 years |

| NY Annual Filing Fee | \$25 | Annual (for LLCs with <\$100K income) |

| Registered Agent (if needed) | \$0–\$199/yr | Included in ZenBusiness Premium, or use your own address |

| **Total Annual (after Year 1)** | **\$224–\$423/yr** | |

3. Brand Startup Costs (Estimated)

| Item | Estimated Cost | Notes |

|-----|-----|-----|

| Logo finalization & brand identity | \$0–\$500 | Almost done per your update |

| Product manufacturing (first run) | \$2,000–\$10,000 | Depends on product type, quantity, manufacturer |

| Product samples | \$200–\$1,000 | Before committing to full production |

| Packaging & labels | \$500–\$2,000 | Custom packaging for the brand |

| Website & domain | \$15–\$50/mo | Domain + hosting or Shopify |

| Social media content creation | \$0–\$1,000 | Can bootstrap or hire |

| Hamptons pop-up (space rental) | \$2,000–\$10,000 | Summer season, East Hampton area |

| NYC pop-up (space rental) | \$3,000–\$15,000 | Manhattan/Brooklyn venue |

| Pop-up displays, signage, setup | \$500–\$2,000 | Tables, banners, POS system |

| Insurance (general liability) | \$500–\$1,500/yr | Required for pop-ups |

| Marketing & promotion | \$500–\$3,000 | Flyers, social ads, influencers |

| POS system (Square, etc.) | \$0–\$50 | Square reader is free, processing fees apply |

| Miscellaneous / contingency | \$500–\$1,000 | Always budget for surprises |

4. Additional Expenses

| Item | Cost | Frequency |

|-----|-----|-----|

| Graphic Designer | \$150 | One-time |

| Google Workspace | \$40/mo (~\$480/yr) | Monthly |

5. Total Budget — \$15,000 Initial Investment

Capital Contributions (Equal Split)

Partner	Contribution
Sean DeFaria	\$7,500
Lukas Levine	\$7,500
TOTAL	\$15,000

Where the \$15,000 Goes

Category	Budget
LLC Formation (ZenBusiness Pro + NY fees + publication)	\$1,000
300-Unit Production Run (~\$20-\$30/unit)	\$6,000-\$9,000
Packaging & Labels	\$1,000
Graphic Designer	\$150
Google Workspace (first 3 months)	\$120
Hamptons Pop-Up (space, signage, POS)	\$1,500-\$2,000
Marketing & Promotion	\$1,500-\$2,000
Website / Shopify	\$200-\$400
Insurance (general liability)	\$500
Contingency	\$500-\$1,000
TOTAL	~\$13,000-\$15,000

6. Key Notes

- New LLC** — Hamptons New York LLC will be a brand new entity. Neither partner's existing businesses are involved.
- Equal investment, 51/49 ownership** — Both partners invest the same amount. The 51/49 split reflects decision-making authority, not financial contribution.
- File in Suffolk County** (East Hampton address) — cheaper publication costs than NYC.
- Separate bank account** — open under the new LLC immediately. Never mix personal and business funds.
- Track every dollar** — shared spreadsheet or QuickBooks from Day 1.